The Northwest Coast

Stretching from Canada's British Columbia to north California and the coastline, the Northwest region is abundant in materials and resources with a warm temperature. Most of the food that the natives needed came from fishing in the nearby rivers. The natives in the Northwest region lived on fish, whales, salmon and other seafoods, which allowed them to establish permanent communities instead of a nomadic lifestyle. This distinguishes the Northwest tribes from the other tribes. The communities here were run by a strict social organization that was more complex than organizations in other regions. Here, an individual's social status was influenced by the number and quality of possessions. Furthermore, close ties to the chief leader meant a higher status. Some of the better-known groups who lived in the Northwest region were the Salish, Kwakiutlm, Coos, Chinook and the Haida.